

Final Individual Project (70%)

The final individual project accounts for 70% of your overall grade. Students are expected to design and execute an independent Computational Communication Science project that demonstrates their ability to formulate a research question, collect and analyze data, and apply the fundamental techniques taught in the course.

Your submission must include **(1) a PDF report** and **(2) a .zip folder** containing all relevant code and output files.

1 PDF Report (recommended length: 5–6 pages)

Your written report should include the following components:

A. Introduction (1–2 pages)

- A clearly formulated research question;
- Any subquestions and/or hypotheses;
- References to relevant literature, including course readings where appropriate.

B. Analytic strategy

- A transparent overview of your methodological approach;
- A justification for the choice of techniques, referring explicitly to methods discussed during the course.

C. Dataset description

- A carefully collected and relevant dataset of non-trivial size (e.g., retrieved via APIs or constructed by combining existing datasets);
- An explorative description of the dataset;
- A brief argument for why this dataset is suitable for your research question.

D. Conclusion

- A well-substantiated answer to your research question;
- A reflection on limitations and directions for future research.

2 Project Files (.zip Folder)

Alongside the PDF report, include a compressed folder containing:

- **Python scripts** for data collection, preprocessing, analysis, and visualization. The scripts should be well-documented, reproducible, and tailored to the student's own project.
- **Output files**, such as tables, plots, or summary statistics.
- **A README file** describing:
 - how to run the code,
 - what each script does,
 - any software or library requirements.

3 Requirements and Guidance

Depending on the chosen topic, the student must apply at least one of the techniques taught in the course. Projects should present an explorative description of the dataset and apply fundamental analytical techniques.

During lab sessions and individual consultations, students may discuss:

- the scope of the project;
- the methodological requirements that the project must meet;
- how the chosen analytical methods contribute to the final grade.

Important notes

- All external data sources and code (libraries, templates, tutorials) must be properly cited.
- Code must be tailored to the student's own project and must run without errors.
- Students are free to select any topic of interest—even outside traditional communication science or the social sciences—provided it is framed around a research question and based on original data analysis.

4 Submission Instructions

Please submit both:

1. the PDF report, and
2. the .zip folder containing your code and outputs

via Canvas.

Deadline: Submission is open until **17 December, 23:59**. If you submit after the deadline, points will be deducted.